

[SCHOOL NAME — PLACEHOLDER LETTERHEAD]

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Class 3 EVS — CA-1 (Hard) — Answer Key

Class : 3

Subject : EVS (Our Wondrous World)

Max Marks : 50

Duration : 1 Hr 30 Min

Syllabus: Chapters 1–3 — Family and Friends, Going to the Mela, Celebrating Festivals

General Instructions: All questions are compulsory. For Section A, write the correct option letter.

ANSWER KEY

SECTION A — Multiple Choice Questions (1 Mark each)

1. Which statement best explains why "family" cannot be defined by a single fixed structure? (1 Mark)

A. All families must have the same number of members

B. Families vary widely in structure, culture, and circumstances, but all can provide love and support ✓

C. Only traditional families are valid

D. Family structure never changes over time

2. A mela brings together local sellers, entertainers, and visitors. Which best explains why this combination benefits the wider community? (1 Mark)

A. It only benefits sellers

B. It supports local livelihoods while also giving the community a shared space for enjoyment and connection ✓

C. It has no real benefit

D. It only benefits visitors from other places

3. Why might it be inaccurate to say that all Indian families celebrate every festival the same way? (1 Mark)

A. Because festivals do not exist in India

B. Because regional, cultural, and family-specific traditions cause variations even within the same festival ✓

C. Because only one festival exists in India

D. Because celebrations never differ at all

4. If two communities exchange sweets or visit each other during each other's festivals, what deeper social value does this practice reflect? (1 Mark)

A. Competition between communities

B. Mutual respect, goodwill, and social harmony ✓

C. Avoidance of other cultures

D. Strict separation between groups

5. Which of these best describes the relationship between safety rules and enjoyment at a crowded event like a mela? (1 Mark)

A. Safety rules always ruin enjoyment

B. Safety rules and enjoyment can work together, allowing people to have fun while staying protected ✓

C. Enjoyment is impossible with safety rules

D. Safety rules are unnecessary in crowded places

6. What might be the long-term social impact if children never experienced community events like melas or festivals? (1 Mark)

A. No impact at all

B. They might have fewer opportunities to develop broader social awareness and community bonds beyond family ✓

C. They would automatically become more social

D. It would only affect their eating habits

7. How does bargaining at a mela reflect a real-world social and economic skill? (1 Mark)

A. It has no real connection to life skills

B. It reflects negotiation and communication skills useful in many real-world situations ✓

C. It teaches dishonesty

D. It is only relevant to sellers, not buyers

8. Which best explains why festivals often include both religious/traditional elements AND purely fun activities (like fairs or games)? (1 Mark)

A. This combination is accidental and meaningless

B. It reflects how festivals often blend meaningful tradition with joyful community celebration ✓

C. Fun activities replace all meaning in festivals

D. Traditional elements are always separate from celebration

SECTION B — Short Answer Questions (2 Marks each)

1. Critically explain why defining a "normal" family structure can be misleading, using reasoning rather than just examples. (0 Marks)

► Since families exist in many valid forms - single-parent, joint, extended, or blended - defining one structure as "normal" risks excluding or undervaluing children who do not fit that specific mould, when what truly matters for wellbeing is the quality of care and support, not the specific structure.

2. Analyse how a mela can act as an informal classroom for life skills, beyond just being a place of entertainment. (0 Marks)

► At a mela, children can practise money management by deciding what to spend on, develop social skills through interacting with sellers and other visitors, and learn about safety and responsibility by staying aware of their surroundings - all valuable life skills gained through a fun, real-world setting rather than formal instruction.

3. Discuss why regional variations in how a single festival (like a harvest festival) is celebrated across India might strengthen, rather than weaken, national unity. (0 Marks)

► Even though the specific customs may differ by region, the shared purpose behind such festivals - like gratitude for harvest - creates a common thread that connects different communities, showing that unity does not require identical traditions, but rather a shared spirit of celebration and appreciation.

4. Explain the concept of "unity in diversity" using the example of multiple festivals being celebrated within one country, and discuss any potential challenges this diversity might also present. (0 Marks)
- Unity in diversity means that despite having many different festivals, religions, and traditions, people can still come together as one nation; however, potential challenges include occasional misunderstandings between communities or the need for extra effort to ensure every community feels equally respected and included.
5. Evaluate whether strict safety rules at a mela might sometimes reduce a child's sense of independence, and discuss how a balance might be achieved. (0 Marks)
- While very strict rules could limit a child's sense of independence and exploration, a balanced approach - such as allowing supervised freedom to explore a few stalls independently while still remaining within sight of a guardian - can help children build confidence and decision-making skills without compromising their safety.
6. Discuss how economic activity at a mela (buying, selling, bargaining) might indirectly teach children about broader economic concepts, even without formal lessons. (0 Marks)
- Through observing or participating in buying and selling at a mela, children can begin to understand basic economic ideas like value, pricing, and negotiation, which lays an early, practical foundation for understanding more complex economic concepts later in life.
7. Analyse why community celebrations of festivals (not just family celebrations) might be particularly important in urban areas where neighbours often do not know each other well. (0 Marks)
- In urban areas, where fast-paced life can lead to weaker neighbourly connections, community festival celebrations provide a valuable opportunity for neighbours to interact, build trust, and form a stronger sense of community that might not otherwise develop naturally.
8. Discuss the potential emotional impact on a child who experiences getting lost at a mela, and how well-taught safety practices might reduce this impact. (0 Marks)
- Getting lost can be frightening and stressful for a child, but if they have been taught clear safety practices - like staying calm and finding a trusted adult - the situation may be resolved more quickly and with less lasting emotional distress, showing the real-world value of safety education beyond just physical protection.
9. Explain how the theme of "sharing" appears in both family life and festival traditions, and discuss why this repeated theme might be intentional in how children are taught these concepts. (0 Marks)
- Sharing appears in family life through daily acts like sharing meals or chores, and in festivals through traditions like exchanging sweets or gifts; this repetition is likely intentional, as reinforcing the same value of sharing across different contexts helps children internalise it as an important, consistent principle rather than a one-time lesson.
10. Critically assess whether visiting melas or celebrating festivals should be considered educational, even though they are often seen mainly as fun or leisure activities. (0 Marks)
- Although melas and festivals are often seen purely as fun, they carry genuine educational value - teaching social skills, cultural awareness, money management, and community values - showing that learning does not only happen in a classroom, but also through meaningful real-world experiences.

SECTION C — Short Answer Questions (Explain) (3 Marks each)

1. Critically analyse how the three chapters (Family and Friends, Going to the Mela, Celebrating Festivals) together represent expanding circles of a child's social world, from the most personal to the most communal. (0 Marks)
- "Family and Friends" represents the innermost, most personal circle, focusing on close relationships that shape a child's earliest understanding of care and belonging.
 - "Going to the Mela" expands this circle to the local community, introducing children to interactions with strangers, sellers, and the wider public in a structured, fun setting.
 - "Celebrating Festivals" expands the circle even further, connecting children to cultural and even national identity through shared traditions across diverse communities.
 - This structure - moving from personal family, to local community, to broader cultural identity - mirrors how a child's social world naturally grows over time, making the unit's sequence thoughtfully designed.
2. Evaluate the claim that "diversity in festivals strengthens national unity" by considering both supporting and challenging perspectives. (0 Marks)
- Supporting this claim, shared celebration of diverse festivals can create mutual respect and a sense of belonging to one nation that embraces many traditions, as people often join in each other's celebrations.
 - However, a challenging perspective might note that without conscious effort, diversity could also lead to communities remaining separate, celebrating only within their own groups without genuine interaction with others.
 - Overall, diversity has strong potential to strengthen unity, but this outcome depends on active inclusion and interaction between communities, not diversity alone.
3. Discuss how the life skills learned at a mela (money management, safety awareness, social interaction) might connect to skills needed in adult life, using specific examples. (0 Marks)
- Money management at a mela, like deciding how to spend a limited amount wisely, connects to budgeting skills needed for handling personal finances as an adult.
 - Safety awareness, like staying alert in a crowd, connects to broader real-world safety skills needed when navigating public spaces, such as travelling in a city.
 - Social interaction with sellers or other visitors builds early communication and negotiation skills that are valuable in adult workplaces and daily life.

4. Analyse the role of tradition versus change in festival celebrations, and discuss whether strictly preserving old customs or embracing new practices is more valuable for a community. (0 Marks)

- Strictly preserving old customs helps maintain a strong cultural identity and connects communities to their history and ancestors.
- Embracing new practices can keep festivals relevant and engaging for younger generations, ensuring the tradition continues to be celebrated actively rather than fading away.
- A balanced approach - honouring the core meaning of a festival while allowing some flexibility in how it is celebrated - is often more valuable, as it preserves cultural identity while keeping traditions alive and meaningful for future generations.

SECTION D — Long Answer Questions (5 Marks each)

1. Write a comprehensive essay analysing how "Family and Friends", "Going to the Mela", and "Celebrating Festivals" together build a child's understanding of belonging - from the personal (family) to the communal (society) to the cultural (festivals) - and discuss why this progression is educationally significant. (0 Marks)

- "Family and Friends" establishes the innermost circle of belonging, teaching children about love, responsibility, and close relationships through their immediate family and friendships.
- "Going to the Mela" extends this sense of belonging outward to the local community, exposing children to public interactions, safety practices, and the shared enjoyment of community spaces.
- "Celebrating Festivals" further broadens this understanding to a cultural and national level, showing children how diverse traditions across the country can coexist and be celebrated together, reinforcing the idea of unity in diversity.
- This progression - from family, to community, to culture - is educationally significant because it mirrors the natural way children's social awareness expands as they grow, ensuring that each stage builds thoughtfully on the previous one, ultimately preparing children to become socially aware, culturally respectful, and community-minded individuals.

2. Imagine you are designing an activity for younger students (Class 1) to help them understand the value of family, community, and festivals, drawing on ideas from all three chapters. Describe the activity in detail and explain how it addresses each theme. (0 Marks)

- This is a creative, open-ended design task; there is no single correct answer, but strong responses should thoughtfully address family, community (mela-like), and festival themes.
- A strong answer might design an activity like a classroom "mini-mela," where students bring items representing their family traditions or favourite festival customs to share with classmates, combining elements of a fair (Going to the Mela) with cultural sharing (Celebrating Festivals) and personal identity (Family and Friends).
- The explanation should clearly connect each part of the activity back to the specific themes and lessons from the three chapters, showing a thoughtful integration of all the concepts studied.